

By BOB JACOBSEN
Republic Sports Writer

EL PASO — The last paragraph of Texas-El Paso's baseball release this week may very well tell the Miners' plan against Arizona's Wildcats today and Saturday:

"Coach Andy Cohen will probably go with Roy Stringer (6-3, 3.75 earned run average), Dan Modlinski (3-5, 5.83) and Jeff Hogan (3-4, 5.16), not necessarily in that order."

With emphasis on "not necessarily in that order."

The Wildcats, top-ranked in the country and possessors of a glossy 50-4 record, head into the Miner series almost certainly needing three wins to keep a game ahead of Arizona State in the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division race.

And the Miners know it.

Cohen, the full time El Paso beer distributor and part-time UTEP baseball coach, may be saving ace Stringer for one of Saturday's games' which he feels he has a better chance to win.

The reason is simple — Dave Brueker.

The senior righthanded pitching ace for UA has been phenomenal in his last three starts. He has a scoreless inning streak of 23 1/3 innings, with 34 strikeouts in his last three appearances, and 29 since his gooseegg string began.

He has hurled four shut-outs this season, and his 13 wins place him one short of Rich Hinton's school record.

Stringer, of course, is the Prescott youngster who whipped ASU in the WAC opener,